[8] Who planned this against Tyre, the bestower of crowns, whose traders are princes, whose merchants are renowned on the earth? [9] The LORD of Hosts planned it, to defile all its glorious beauty, to disgrace all the renowned of the earth. [10] Cultivate your land like the Nile, O Daughter of Tarshish; there is no longer a harbor. [11] The LORD has stretched out His hand over the sea; He has made kingdoms tremble. He has given a command that the strongholds of Canaan be destroyed.

[12] He said, "You shall rejoice no more, O oppressed Virgin Daughter of Sidon. Get up and cross over to Cyprus— even there you will find no rest." [13] Look at the land of the Chaldeans— a people now of no account. The Assyrians destined it for the desert creatures; they set up their siege towers and stripped its palaces. They brought it to ruin. [14] Wail, O ships of Tarshish, for your harbor has been destroyed! [15] At that time Tyre will be forgotten for seventy years—the span of a king's life. But at the end of seventy years, it will happen to Tyre as in the song of the harlot: [16] "Take up your harp, stroll through the city, O forgotten harlot. Make sweet melody, sing many a song, so you will be remembered." [17] And at the end of seventy years, the LORD will restore Tyre. Then she will return to hire as a prostitute and sell herself to all the kingdoms on the face of the earth. [18] Yet her profits and wages will be set apart to the LORD; they will not be stored or saved, for her profit will go to those who live before the LORD, for abundant food and fine clothing.

24 Behold, the LORD lays waste the earth and leaves it in ruins. He will twist its surface and scatter its inhabitants— [2] people and priest alike, servant and master, maid and mistress, buyer and seller, lender and borrower, creditor and debtor. [3] The earth will be utterly laid waste and thoroughly plundered. For the LORD has spoken this word. [4] The earth mourns and withers; the world languishes and fades; the exalted of the earth waste away. [5] The earth is defiled by its people; they have transgressed the laws; they have overstepped the decrees and broken the everlasting covenant. [6] Therefore a curse has consumed the earth, and its inhabitants must bear the guilt; the earth's dwellers have been burned, and only a few survive.

[7] The new wine dries up, the vine withers. All the merrymakers now groan. [8] The joyful tambourines have ceased; the noise of revelers has stopped; the joyful harp is silent. [9] They no longer sing and drink wine; strong drink is bitter to those who consume it. [10] The city of chaos is shattered; every house is closed to entry.

[11] In the streets they cry out for wine. All joy turns to gloom; rejoicing is exiled from the land. [12] The city is left in ruins; its gate is reduced to rubble. [13] So will it be on the earth and among the nations, like a harvested olive tree, like a gleaning after a grape harvest. [14] They raise their voices, they shout for joy; from the west they proclaim the majesty of the LORD.

[15] Therefore glorify the LORD in the east. Extol the name of the LORD, the God of Israel in the islands of the sea. [16] From the ends of the earth we hear singing: "Glory to the Righteous One." But I said, "I am wasting away! I am wasting away! Woe is me." The treacherous betray; the treacherous deal in treachery. [17] Terror and pit and snare await you, O dweller of the earth. [18] Whoever flees the sound of panic will fall into the pit, and whoever climbs from the pit will be caught in the snare. For the windows of heaven are open, and the foundations of the earth are shaken. [19] The earth is utterly broken apart, the earth is split open, the earth is shaken violently. [20] The earth staggers like a drunkard and sways like a shack. Earth's rebellion weighs it down, and it falls, never to rise again. [21] In that day the LORD will punish the host of heaven above and the kings of the earth below. [22] They will be gathered together like prisoners in a pit. They will be confined to a dungeon and punished after many days. [23] The moon will be confounded and the sun will be ashamed; for the LORD of Hosts will reign on Mount Zion and in Jerusalem, and before His elders with great glory.

25 O LORD, You are my God! I will exalt You; I will praise Your name. For You have worked wonders— plans formed long ago— in perfect faithfulness. [2] Indeed, You have made the city a heap of rubble, the fortified town a ruin. The fortress of strangers is a city no more; it will never be rebuilt. [3] Therefore, a strong people will honor You. The cities of ruthless nations will revere You. [4] For You have been a refuge for the poor, a stronghold for the needy in distress, a refuge from the storm, a shade from the heat. For the breath of the ruthless is like rain against a wall, [5] like heat in a dry land. You subdue the uproar of foreigners. As the shade of a cloud cools the heat, so the song of the ruthless is silenced. [6] On this mountain the LORD of Hosts will prepare a banquet for all the peoples, a feast of aged wine, of choice meat, of finely aged wine. [7] On this mountain He will swallow up the shroud that enfolds all peoples, the sheet that covers all nations; [8] He will swallow up death forever. The Lord GOD will wipe away the tears from every face and remove the disgrace of His people from the whole earth. For the LORD has spoken. [9] And in that day it will be said, "Surely this is our God; we have waited for Him, and He has saved us. This is the LORD for whom we have waited. Let us rejoice and be glad in His salvation." [10] For the hand of the LORD will rest on this mountain. But Moab will be trampled in his place as straw is trodden into the dung pile. [11] He will spread out his hands within it, as a swimmer spreads his arms to swim. His pride will be brought low, despite the skill of his hands. [12] The high-walled fortress will be brought down, cast to the ground, into the dust.

26 In that day this song will be sung in the land of Judah: We have a strong city; salvation is established as its walls and ramparts. [2] Open the gates so a righteous nation may enter— one that remains faithful. [3] You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You. [4] Trust in the LORD forever, because GOD the LORD is the Rock eternal. [5] For He has humbled those who dwell on high; He lays the lofty city low. He brings it down to the ground; He casts it into the dust. [6] Feet trample it down— the feet of the oppressed, the steps of the poor.

[7] The path of the righteous is level; You clear a straight path for the upright. [8] Yes, we wait for You, O LORD; we walk in the path of Your judgments. Your name and renown are the desire of our souls. [9] My soul longs for You in the night; indeed, my spirit seeks You at dawn. For when Your judgments come upon the earth, the people of the world learn righteousness.

[10] Though grace is shown to the wicked man, he does not learn righteousness. In the land of righteousness he acts unjustly and fails to see the majesty of the LORD. [11] O LORD, Your hand is upraised, but they do not see it. They will see Your zeal for Your people and be put to shame. The fire set for Your enemies will consume them! [12] O LORD, You will establish peace for us. For all that we have accomplished, You have done for us. [13] O LORD our God, other lords besides You have had dominion, but Your name alone do we confess.

[14] The dead will not live; the departed spirits will not rise. Therefore You have punished and destroyed them; You have wiped out all memory of them. [15] You have enlarged the nation, O LORD; You have enlarged the nation. You have gained glory for Yourself; You have extended all the borders of the land. [16] O LORD, they sought You in their distress; when You disciplined them, they poured out a quiet prayer. [17] As a woman with child about to give birth writhes and cries out in pain, so were we in Your presence, O LORD. [18] We were with child; we writhed in pain; but we gave birth to wind. We have given no salvation to the earth, nor brought any life into the world. [19] Your dead will live; their bodies will rise. Awake and sing, you who dwell in the dust! For your dew is like the dew of the morning, and the earth will bring forth her dead. [20] Go, my people, enter your rooms and shut your doors behind you. Hide yourselves a little while until the wrath has passed. [21] For behold, the LORD is coming out of His dwelling to punish the inhabitants of the earth for their iniquity. The earth will reveal her bloodshed and will no longer conceal her slain.

27 In that day the LORD will take His sharp, great, and mighty sword, and bring judgment on Leviathan the fleeing serpent—Leviathan the coiling serpent—and He will slay the dragon of the sea. [2] In that day: "Sing about a fruitful vineyard." [3] I, the LORD, am its keeper; I water it continually. I guard it night and day so no one can disturb it; [4] I am not angry. If only thorns and briers confronted Me, I would march and trample them, I would burn them to the ground. [5] "Or let them lay claim to My protection; let them make peace with Me— yes, let them make peace with Me." [6] In the days to come, Jacob will take root. Israel will bud and blossom and fill the whole world with fruit. [7] Has the LORD struck Israel as He struck her oppressors? Was she killed like those who slayed her? [8] By warfare and exile You contended with her and removed her with a fierce wind, as on the day the east wind blows. [9] Therefore Jacob's guilt will be atoned for, and the full fruit of the removal of his sin will be this: When he makes all the altar stones like crushed bits of chalk, no Asherah poles or incense altars will remain standing. [10] For the fortified city lies deserted— a homestead abandoned, a wilderness forsaken. There the calves graze, and there they lie down; they strip its branches bare. [11] When its limbs are dry, they are broken off. Women come and use them for kindling; for this is a people without understanding. Therefore their Maker has no compassion on them, and their Creator shows them no favor. [12] In that day the LORD will thresh from the flowing Euphrates to the Wadi of Egypt, and you, O Israelites, will be gathered one by one. [13] And in that day a great ram's horn will sound, and those who were perishing in Assyria will come forth with those who were exiles in Egypt. And they will worship the LORD on the holy mountain in Jerusalem.

28 Woe to the majestic crown of Ephraim's drunkards, to the fading flower of his glorious splendor, set on the summit above the fertile valley, the pride of those overcome by wine. [2] Behold, the Lord has one who is strong and mighty. Like a hailstorm or destructive tempest, like a driving rain or flooding downpour, he will smash that crown to the ground. [3] The majestic crown of Ephraim's drunkards will be trampled underfoot. [4] The fading flower of his beautiful splendor, set on the summit above the fertile valley, will be like a ripe fig before the summer harvest: Whoever sees it will take it in his hand and swallow it. [5] On that day the LORD of Hosts will be a crown of glory, a diadem of splendor to the remnant of His people, [6] a spirit of justice to him who sits in judgment, and a strength to those who repel the onslaught at the gate. [7] These also stagger from wine and stumble from strong drink: Priests and prophets reel from strong drink and are befuddled by wine. They stumble because of strong drink, muddled in their visions and stumbling in their judgments. [8] For all their tables are covered with vomit; there is not a place without filth.

[9] Whom is He trying to teach? To whom is He explaining His message? To infants just weaned from milk? To babies removed from the breast? [10] For they hear:

"Order on order, order on order, line on line, line on line; a little here, a little there." [11] Indeed, with mocking lips and foreign tongues, He will speak to this people [12] to whom He has said: "This is the place of rest, let the weary rest; this is the place of repose." But they would not listen.

[13] Then the word of the LORD to them will become: "Order on order, order on order, line on line, line on line; a little here, a little there," so that they will go stumbling backward and will be injured, ensnared, and captured. [14] Therefore hear the word of the LORD, O scoffers who rule this people in Jerusalem. [15] For you said, "We have made a covenant with death; we have fashioned an agreement with Sheol. When the overwhelming scourge passes through it will not touch us, because we have made lies our refuge and falsehood our hiding place." [16] So this is what the Lord GOD says: "See, I lay a stone in Zion, a tested stone, a precious cornerstone, a sure foundation; the one who believes will never be shaken." [17] I will make justice the measuring line and righteousness the level. Hail will sweep away your refuge of lies, and water will flood your hiding place. [18] Your covenant with death will be dissolved, and your agreement with Sheol will not stand. When the overwhelming scourge passes through, you will be trampled by it.

[19] "As often as it passes through, it will carry you away; it will sweep through morning after morning, by day and by night." The understanding of this message will bring sheer terror. [20] Indeed, the bed is too short to stretch out on, and the blanket too small to wrap around you. [21] For the LORD will rise up as at Mount Perazim. He will rouse Himself as in the Valley of Gibeon, to do His work, His strange work, and to perform His task, His disturbing task. [22] So now, do not mock, or your shackles will become heavier. Indeed, I have heard from the Lord GOD of Hosts a decree of destruction against the whole land. [23] Listen and hear my voice. Pay attention and hear what I say. [24] Does the plowman plow for planting every day? Does he continuously loosen and harrow the soil? [25] When he has leveled its surface, does he not sow caraway and scatter cumin? He plants wheat in rows and barley in plots, and rye within its border. [26] For his God instructs and teaches him properly. [27] Surely caraway is not threshed with a sledge, and the wheel of a cart is not rolled over the cumin. But caraway is beaten out with a stick, and cumin with a rod. [28] Grain for bread must be ground, but it is not endlessly threshed. Though the wheels of the cart roll over it, the horses do not crush it. [29] This also comes from the LORD of Hosts, who is wonderful in counsel and excellent in wisdom.

29 Woe to you, O Ariel, the city of Ariel where David camped! Year upon year let your festivals recur. [2] And I will constrain Ariel, and there will be mourning and lamentation; she will be like an altar hearth before Me. [3] I will camp in a circle around you; I will besiege you with towers and set up siege works against you. [4] You will be brought low, you will speak from the ground, and out of the dust your words will be muffled. Your voice will be like a spirit from the ground; your speech will whisper out of the dust. [5] But your many foes will be like fine dust, the multitude of the ruthless like blowing chaff. Then suddenly, in an instant, [6] you will be visited by the LORD of Hosts with thunder and earthquake and loud noise, with windstorm and tempest and consuming flame of fire. [7] All the many nations going out to battle against Ariel— even all who war against her, laying siege and attacking her— will be like a dream, like a vision in the night, [8] as when a hungry man dreams he is eating, then awakens still hungry; as when a thirsty man dreams he is drinking, then awakens faint and parched. So will it be for all the many nations who go to battle against Mount Zion. [9] Stop and be astonished; blind yourselves and be sightless; be drunk, but not with wine; stagger, but not from strong drink. [10] For the LORD has poured out on you a spirit of deep sleep. He has shut your eyes, O prophets; He has covered your heads, O seers. [11] And the entire vision will be to you like the words sealed in a scroll. If it is handed to someone to read, he will say, "I cannot, because it is sealed." [12] Or if the scroll is handed to one unable to read, he will say, "I cannot read." [13] Therefore the Lord said: "These people draw near to Me with their mouths and honor Me with their lips, but their hearts are far from Me. Their worship of Me is but rules taught by men." [14] "Therefore I will again confound these people with wonder upon wonder. The wisdom of the wise will vanish, and the intelligence of the intelligent will be hidden." [15] Woe to those who dig deep to hide their plans from the LORD. In darkness they do their works and say, "Who sees us, and who will know?"

[16] You have turned things upside down, as if the potter were regarded as clay. Shall what is formed say to him who formed it, "He did not make me"? Can the pottery say of the potter, "He has no understanding"? [17] In a very short time, will not Lebanon become an orchard, and the orchard seem like a forest? [18] On that day the deaf will hear the words of the scroll, and out of the deep darkness the eyes of the blind will see.

[19] The humble will increase their joy in the LORD, and the poor among men will rejoice in the Holy One of Israel. [20] For the ruthless will vanish, the mockers will disappear, and all who look for evil will be cut down— [21] those who indict a man with a word, who ensnare the mediator at the gate, and who with false charges deprive the innocent of justice. [22] Therefore the LORD who redeemed Abraham says of the house of Jacob: "No longer will Jacob be ashamed and no more will his face grow pale." [23] For when he sees his children around him, the work of My hands, they will honor My name, they will sanctify the Holy One of Jacob, and they will stand in awe of the God of Israel. [24] "Then the wayward in spirit will come to understanding, and those who grumble will accept instruction."

30 "Woe to the rebellious children," declares the LORD, "to those who carry out a plan that is not Mine, who form an alliance, but against My will, heaping up sin upon sin." [2] They set out to go down to Egypt without asking My advice, to seek shelter under Pharaoh's protection and take refuge in Egypt's shade. [3] But Pharaoh's protection will become your shame, and the refuge of Egypt's shade your disgrace. [4] For though their princes are at Zoan and their envoys have arrived in Hanes, [5] "everyone will be put to shame because of a people useless to them. They cannot be of help; they are good for nothing but shame and reproach." [6] This is the burden against the beasts of the Negev: Through a land of hardship and distress, of lioness and lion, of viper and flying serpent, they carry their wealth on the backs of donkeys and their treasures on the humps of camels, to a people of no profit to them. [7] Egypt's help is futile and empty; therefore I have called her Rahab Who Sits Still. [8] Go now, write it on a tablet in their presence and inscribe it on a scroll; it will be for the days to come, a witness forever and ever. [9] These are rebellious people, deceitful children, children unwilling to obey the LORD's instruction. [10] They say to the seers, "Stop seeing visions!" and to the prophets, "Do not prophesy to us the truth! Speak to us pleasant words; prophesy illusions."

[11] "Get out of the way; turn off the road. Rid us of the Holy One of Israel!" [12] Therefore this is what the Holy One of Israel says: "Because you have rejected this message, trusting in oppression and relying on deceit," [13] this iniquity of yours is like a breach about to fail, a bulge in a high wall, whose collapse will come suddenly — in an instant! [14] "It will break in pieces like a potter's jar, shattered so that no fragment can be found. Not a shard will be found in the dust large enough to scoop the coals from a hearth or to skim the water from a cistern." [15] For the Lord GOD, the Holy One of Israel, has said: "By repentance and rest you would be saved; your strength would lie in quiet confidence— but you were not willing." [16] "No," you say, "we will flee on horses." Therefore you will flee! "We will ride swift horses," but your pursuers will be faster. [17] A thousand will flee at the threat of one; at the threat of five you will all flee, until you are left alone like a pole on a mountaintop, like a banner on a hill. [18] Therefore the LORD longs to be gracious to you; therefore He rises to show you compassion, for the LORD is a just God. Blessed are all who wait for Him. [19] O people in Zion who dwell in Jerusalem, you will weep no more. He will surely be gracious when you cry for help; when He hears, He will answer you. [20] The Lord will give you the bread of adversity and the water of affliction, but your Teacher will no longer hide Himself—with your own eyes you will see Him.

[21] And whether you turn to the right or to the left, your ears will hear this command behind you: "This is the way. Walk in it."

[22] So you will desecrate your silver-plated idols and your gold-plated images. You will throw them away like menstrual cloths, saying to them, "Be gone!" [23] Then He will send rain for the seed that you have sown in the ground, and the food that comes from your land will be rich and plentiful. On that day your cattle will graze in open pastures. [24] The oxen and donkeys that work the ground will eat salted fodder, winnowed with shovel and pitchfork. [25] And from every high mountain and every raised hill, streams of water will flow in the day of great slaughter, when the towers fall. [26] The light of the moon will be as bright as the sun, and the light of the sun will be seven times brighter—like the light of seven days— on the day that the LORD binds up the brokenness of His people and heals the wounds He has inflicted. [27] Behold, the Name of the LORD comes from afar, with burning anger and dense smoke. His lips are full of fury, and His tongue is like a consuming fire. [28] His breath is like a rushing torrent that rises to the neck. He comes to sift the nations in a sieve of destruction; He bridles the jaws of the peoples to lead them astray. [29] You will sing as on the night of a holy festival, and your heart will rejoice like one who walks to the music of a flute, going up to the mountain of the LORD, to the Rock of Israel. [30] And the LORD will cause His majestic voice to be heard and His mighty arm to be revealed, striking in angry wrath with a flame of consuming fire, and with cloudburst, storm, and hailstones. [31] For Assyria will be shattered at the voice of the LORD; He will strike them with His scepter. [32] And with every stroke of the rod of punishment that the LORD brings down on them, the tambourines and lyres will sound as He battles with weapons brandished. [33] For Topheth has long been prepared; it has been made ready for the king. Its funeral pyre is deep and wide, with plenty of fire and wood. The breath of the LORD, like a torrent of burning sulfur, sets it ablaze.

31 Woe to those who go down to Egypt for help, who rely on horses, who trust in their abundance of chariots and in their multitude of horsemen. They do not look to the Holy One of Israel; they do not seek the LORD. [2] Yet He too is wise and brings disaster; He does not call back His words. He will rise up against the house of the wicked and against the allies of evildoers. [3] But the Egyptians are men, not God; their horses are flesh, not spirit. When the LORD stretches out His hand, the helper will stumble, and the one he helps will fall; both will perish together. [4] For this is what the LORD has said to me: "Like a lion roaring or a young lion over its prey— and though a band of shepherds is called out against it, it is not terrified by their shouting or subdued by their clamor— so the LORD of Hosts will come down to do battle on Mount Zion and its heights." [5] "Like birds hovering overhead,

so the LORD of Hosts will protect Jerusalem. He will shield it and deliver it; He will pass over it and preserve it." [6] Return to the One against whom you have so blatantly rebelled, O children of Israel. [7] For on that day, every one of you will reject the idols of silver and gold that your own hands have sinfully made. [8] "Then Assyria will fall, but not by the sword of man; a sword will devour them, but not one made by mortals. They will flee before the sword, and their young men will be put to forced labor." [9] "Their rock will pass away for fear, and their princes will panic at the sight of the battle standard," declares the LORD, whose fire is in Zion, whose furnace is in Jerusalem.

32 Behold, a king will reign in righteousness, and princes will rule with justice. [2] Each will be like a shelter from the wind, a refuge from the storm, like streams of water in a dry land, like the shadow of a great rock in an arid land. [3] Then the eyes of those who see will no longer be closed, and the ears of those who hear will listen. [4] The mind of the rash will know and understand, and the stammering tongue will speak clearly and fluently. [5] No longer will a fool be called noble, nor a scoundrel be respected. [6] For a fool speaks foolishness; his mind plots iniquity. He practices ungodliness and speaks falsely about the LORD; he leaves the hungry empty and deprives the thirsty of drink. [7] The weapons of the scoundrel are destructive; he hatches plots to destroy the poor with lies, even when the plea of the needy is just. [8] But a noble man makes honorable plans; he stands up for worthy causes. [9] Stand up, you complacent women; listen to me. Give ear to my word, you overconfident daughters.

[10] In a little more than a year you will tremble, O secure ones. For the grape harvest will fail and the fruit harvest will not arrive. [11] Shudder, you ladies of leisure; tremble, you daughters of complacency. Strip yourselves bare and put sackcloth around your waists. [12] Beat your breasts for the pleasant fields, for the fruitful vines, [13] and for the land of my people, overgrown with thorns and briers— even for every house of merriment in this city of revelry. [14] For the palace will be forsaken, the busy city abandoned. The hill and the watchtower will become caves forever— the delight of wild donkeys and a pasture for flocks— [15] until the Spirit is poured out upon us from on high. Then the desert will be an orchard, and the orchard will seem like a forest. [16] Then justice will inhabit the wilderness, and righteousness will dwell in the fertile field. [17] The work of righteousness will be peace; the service of righteousness will be quiet confidence forever. [18] Then my people will dwell in a peaceful place, in safe and secure places of rest. [19] But hail will level the forest, and the city will sink to the depths. [20] Blessed are those who sow beside abundant waters, who let the ox and donkey range freely.

33 Woe to you, O destroyer never destroyed, O traitor never betrayed! When you have finished destroying, you will be destroyed. When you have finished betraying, you will be betrayed. [2] O LORD, be gracious to us! We wait for You. Be our strength every morning and our salvation in time of trouble. [3] The peoples flee the thunder of Your voice; the nations scatter when You rise. [4] Your spoil, O nations, is gathered as by locusts; like a swarm of locusts men sweep over it. [5] The LORD is exalted, for He dwells on high; He has filled Zion with justice and righteousness. [6] He will be the sure foundation for your times, a storehouse of salvation, wisdom, and knowledge. The fear of the LORD is Zion's treasure. [7] Behold, their valiant ones cry aloud in the streets; the envoys of peace weep bitterly.

[8] The highways are deserted; travel has ceased. The treaty has been broken, the witnesses are despised, and human life is disregarded. [9] The land mourns and languishes; Lebanon is ashamed and decayed. Sharon is like a desert; Bashan and Carmel shake off their leaves. [10] "Now I will arise," says the LORD. "Now I will lift Myself up. Now I will be exalted."

[11] You conceive chaff; you give birth to stubble. Your breath is a fire that will consume you. [12] The peoples will be burned to ashes, like thorns cut down and set ablaze. [13] "You who are far off, hear what I have done; you who are near, acknowledge My might." [14] The sinners in Zion are afraid; trembling grips the ungodly: "Who of us can dwell with a consuming fire? Who of us can dwell with everlasting flames?" [15] He who walks righteously and speaks with sincerity, who refuses gain from extortion, whose hand never takes a bribe, who stops his ears against murderous plots and shuts his eyes tightly against evil—

[16] he will dwell on the heights; the mountain fortress will be his refuge; his food will be provided and his water assured. [17] Your eyes will see the King in His beauty and behold a land that stretches afar. [18] Your mind will ponder the former terror: "Where is he who tallies? Where is he who weighs? Where is he who counts the towers?" [19] You will no longer see the insolent, a people whose speech is unintelligible, who stammer in a language you cannot understand. [20] Look upon Zion, the city of our appointed feasts. Your eyes will see Jerusalem, a peaceful pasture, a tent that does not wander; its tent pegs will not be pulled up, nor will any of its cords be broken. [21] But there the Majestic One, our LORD, will be for us a place of rivers and wide canals, where no galley with oars will row, and no majestic vessel will pass. [22] For the LORD is our Judge, the LORD is our lawgiver, the LORD is our King. It is He who will save us. [23] Your ropes are slack; they cannot secure the mast or spread the sail. Then an abundance of spoils will be divided, and even the lame will carry off plunder. [24] And no resident of Zion will say, "I am sick." The people who dwell there will be forgiven of iniquity.

34 Come near, O nations, to listen; pay attention, O peoples. Let the earth hear, and all that fills it, the world and all that springs from it. [2] The LORD is angry with all the nations and furious with all their armies. He will devote them to destruction; He will give them over to slaughter. [3] Their slain will be left unburied, and the stench of their corpses will rise; the mountains will flow with their blood. [4] All the stars of heaven will be dissolved. The skies will be rolled up like a scroll, and all their stars will fall like withered leaves from the vine, like foliage from the fig tree. [5] When My sword has drunk its fill in the heavens, then it will come down upon Edom, upon the people I have devoted to destruction. [6] The sword of the LORD is bathed in blood. It drips with fat— with the blood of lambs and goats, with the fat of the kidneys of rams. For the LORD has a sacrifice in Bozrah, a great slaughter in the land of Edom. [7] And the wild oxen will fall with them, the young bulls with the strong ones. Their land will be drenched with blood, and their soil will be soaked with fat.

[8] For the LORD has a day of vengeance, a year of recompense for the cause of Zion. [9] Edom's streams will be turned to tar, and her soil to sulfur; her land will become a blazing pitch. [10] It will not be quenched—day or night. Its smoke will ascend forever. From generation to generation it will lie desolate; no one will ever again pass through it. [11] The desert owl and screech owl will possess it, and the great owl and raven will dwell in it. The LORD will stretch out over Edom a measuring line of chaos and a plumb line of destruction. [12] No nobles will be left to proclaim a king, and all her princes will come to nothing. [13] Her towers will be overgrown with thorns, her fortresses with thistles and briers. She will become a haunt for jackals, an abode for ostriches. [14] The desert creatures will meet with hyenas, and one wild goat will call to another. There the night creature will settle and find her place of repose. [15] There the owl will make her nest; she will lay and hatch her eggs and gather her brood under her shadow. Even there the birds of prey will gather, each with its mate. [16] Search and read the scroll of the LORD: Not one of these will go missing, not one will lack her mate, because He has ordered it by His mouth, and He will gather them by His Spirit. [17] He has allotted their portion; His hand has distributed it by measure. They will possess it forever; they will dwell in it from generation to generation.

35 The wilderness and the land will be glad; the desert will rejoice and blossom like a rose. [2] It will bloom profusely and rejoice with joy and singing. The glory of Lebanon will be given to it, the splendor of Carmel and Sharon. They will see the glory of the LORD, the splendor of our God. [3] Strengthen the limp hands and steady the feeble knees! [4] Say to those with anxious hearts: "Be strong, do not fear! Behold, your God will come with vengeance. With divine retribution He will come to save you." [5] Then the eyes of the blind will be opened and the ears of the deaf unstopped. [6] Then the lame will leap like a deer and the mute tongue will shout for joy. For waters will gush forth in the wilderness, and streams in the desert. [7] The parched ground will become a pool, the thirsty land springs of water. In the haunt where jackals once lay, there will be grass and reeds and papyrus. [8] And there will be a highway called the Way of Holiness. The unclean will not travel it— only those who walk in the Way— and fools will not stray onto it. [9] No lion will be there, and no vicious beast will go up on it. Such will not be found there, but the redeemed will walk upon it. [10] So the redeemed of the LORD will return and enter Zion with singing, crowned with everlasting joy. Gladness and joy will overtake them, and sorrow and sighing will flee.

36 In the fourteenth year of Hezekiah's reign, Sennacherib king of Assyria attacked and captured all the fortified cities of Judah. [2] And the king of Assyria sent the Rabshakeh, with a great army, from Lachish to King Hezekiah at Jerusalem. And he stopped by the aqueduct of the upper pool, on the road to the Launderer's Field. [3] Then Eliakim son of Hilkiah the palace administrator, Shebna the scribe, and Joah son of Asaph the recorder, went out to him. [4] The Rabshakeh said to them, "Tell Hezekiah that this is what the great king, the king of Assyria, says: What is the basis of this confidence of yours?" [5] You claim to have a strategy and strength for war, but these are empty words. In whom are you now trusting, that you have rebelled against me? [6] Look now, you are trusting in Egypt, that splintered reed of a staff that will pierce the hand of anyone who leans on it. Such is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all who trust in him.

[7] But if you say to me, 'We trust in the LORD our God,' is He not the One whose high places and altars Hezekiah has removed, saying to Judah and Jerusalem, 'You must worship before this altar'? [8] Now, therefore, make a bargain with my master, the king of Assyria. I will give you two thousand horses—if you can put riders on them! [9] For how can you repel a single officer among the least of my master's servants when you depend on Egypt for chariots and horsemen? [10] "So now, was it apart from the LORD that I have come up against this land to destroy it? The LORD Himself said to me, 'Go up against this land and destroy it.'"

[11] Then Eliakim, Shebna, and Joah said to the Rabshakeh, "Please speak to your servants in Aramaic, since we understand it. Do not speak to us in Hebrew in the hearing of the people on the wall." [12] But the Rabshakeh replied, "Has my master sent me to speak these words only to you and your master, and not to the men

sitting on the wall, who are destined with you to eat their own dung and drink their own urine?" [13] Then the Rabshakeh stood and called out loudly in Hebrew: "Hear the words of the great king, the king of Assyria!"

[14] This is what the king says: Do not let Hezekiah deceive you, for he cannot deliver you. [15] Do not let Hezekiah persuade you to trust in the LORD when he says, 'The LORD will surely deliver us; this city will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.' [16] Do not listen to Hezekiah, for this is what the king of Assyria says: Make peace with me and come out to me. Then every one of you will eat from his own vine and his own fig tree, and drink water from his own cistern, [17] until I come and take you away to a land like your own—a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards. [18] Do not let Hezekiah mislead you when he says, 'The LORD will deliver us.' Has the god of any nation ever delivered his land from the hand of the king of Assyria? [19] Where are the gods of Hamath and Arpad? Where are the gods of Sepharvaim? Have they delivered Samaria from my hand? [20] "Who among all the gods of these lands has delivered his land from my hand? How then can the LORD deliver Jerusalem from my hand?" [21] But the people remained silent and did not answer a word, for Hezekiah had commanded, "Do not answer him." [22] Then Hilkiah's son Eliakim the palace administrator, Shebna the scribe, and Asaph's son Joah the recorder came to Hezekiah with their clothes torn, and they relayed to him the words of the Rabshakeh.

37 On hearing this report, King Hezekiah tore his clothes, put on sackcloth, and entered the house of the LORD. [2] And he sent Eliakim the palace administrator, Shebna the scribe, and the leading priests, all wearing sackcloth, to the prophet Isaiah son of Amoz [3] to tell him, "This is what Hezekiah says: Today is a day of distress, rebuke, and disgrace; for children have come to the point of birth, but there is no strength to deliver them." [4] "Perhaps the LORD your God will hear the words of the Rabshakeh, whom his master the king of Assyria has sent to defy the living God, and He will rebuke him for the words that the LORD your God has heard. Therefore lift up a prayer for the remnant that still survives." [5] So the servants of King Hezekiah went to Isaiah, [6] who replied, "Tell your master that this is what the LORD says: 'Do not be afraid of the words you have heard, with which the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed Me.'" [7] "Behold, I will put a spirit in him so that he will hear a rumor and return to his own land, where I will cause him to fall by the sword.'" [8] When the Rabshakeh heard that the king of Assyria had left Lachish, he withdrew and found the king fighting against Libnah. [9] Now Sennacherib had been warned about Tirhakah king of Cush: "He has set out to fight against you." On hearing this, Sennacherib sent messengers to Hezekiah, saying, [10] "Give this message to Hezekiah king of Judah: 'Do not let your God, in whom you trust, deceive you by saying that Jerusalem will not be delivered into the hand of the king of Assyria.'" [11] Surely you have heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all the other countries, devoting them to destruction. Will you then be spared?

[12] Did the gods of the nations destroyed by my fathers rescue those nations—the gods of Gozan, Haran, and Rezeph, and of the people of Eden in Telassar? [13] "Where are the kings of Hamath, Arpad, Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah?'" [14] So Hezekiah received the letter from the messengers, read it, and went up to the house of the LORD and spread it out before the LORD. [15] And Hezekiah prayed to the LORD: [16] "O LORD of Hosts, God of Israel, enthroned above the cherubim, You alone are God over all the kingdoms of the earth. You made the heavens and the earth." [17] Incline Your ear, O LORD, and hear; open Your eyes, O LORD, and see. Listen to all the words that Sennacherib has sent to defy the living God. [18] Truly, O LORD, the kings of Assyria have laid waste all these countries and their lands. [19] They have cast their gods into the fire and destroyed them, for they were not gods, but only wood and stone—the work of human hands. [20] "And now, O LORD our God, save us from his hand, so that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that You alone, O LORD, are God."

[21] Then Isaiah son of Amoz sent a message to Hezekiah: "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: Because you have prayed to Me concerning Sennacherib king of Assyria," [22] this is the word that the LORD has spoken against him: 'The Virgin Daughter of Zion despises you and mocks you; the Daughter of Jerusalem shakes her head behind you.' [23] Whom have you taunted and blasphemed? Against whom have you raised your voice and lifted your eyes in pride? Against the Holy One of Israel! [24] Through your servants you have taunted the Lord, and you have said: "With my many chariots I have ascended to the heights of the mountains, to the remote peaks of Lebanon. I have cut down its tallest cedars, the finest of its cypresses. I have reached its farthest heights, the densest of its forests."

[25] "I have dug wells and drunk foreign waters. With the soles of my feet I have dried up all the streams of Egypt." [26] Have you not heard? Long ago I ordained it; in days of old I planned it. Now I have brought it to pass, that you should crush fortified cities into piles of rubble. [27] Therefore their inhabitants, devoid of power, are dismayed and ashamed. They are like plants in the field, tender green shoots, grass on the rooftops, scorched before it is grown. [28] But I know your sitting down, your going out and coming in, and your raging against Me. [29] Because your rage and arrogance against Me have reached My ears, I will put My hook in your nose and My bit in your mouth; I will send you back the way you came.' [30] And this will be a sign to you, O Hezekiah: This year you will eat what grows on its own, and in the second year what springs from the same. But in the third year you will sow and reap; you will plant vineyards and eat their fruit. [31] And the surviving remnant of the house of Judah will again take root below and bear fruit above. [32] For a remnant will go forth from Jerusalem, and survivors from Mount Zion. The zeal of the LORD of Hosts will accomplish this. [33] So this is what the LORD says about the king of Assyria: 'He will not enter this city or shoot an arrow into it. He will not come before it with a shield or build up a siege ramp against it.' [34] He will go back the way he came, and he will not enter this city,' declares the LORD. [35] "'I will defend this city and save it for My own sake and for the sake of My servant David.'" [36] Then the angel of the LORD went out and struck down 185,000 men in the camp of the Assyrians. When the people got up the next morning, there were all the dead bodies! [37] So Sennacherib king of Assyria broke camp and withdrew. He returned to Nineveh and stayed there. [38] One day, while he was worshiping in the temple of his god Nisroch, his sons Adrammelech and Sharezer put him to the sword and escaped to the land of Ararat. And his son Esar-haddon reigned in his place.

38 In those days Hezekiah became mortally ill. The prophet Isaiah son of Amoz came to him and said, "This is what the LORD says: 'Put your house in order, for you are about to die; you will not recover.'" [2] Then Hezekiah turned his face to the wall and prayed to the LORD, [3] saying, "Please, O LORD, remember how I have walked before You faithfully and with wholehearted devotion; I have done what was good in Your sight." And Hezekiah wept bitterly. [4] And the word of the LORD came to Isaiah, saying, [5] "Go and tell Hezekiah that this is what the LORD, the God of your father David, says: 'I have heard your prayer; I have seen your tears. Behold, I will add fifteen years to your life.'" [6] And I will deliver you and this city from the hand of the king of Assyria. I will defend this city.

[7] This will be a sign to you from the LORD that He will do what He has promised: [8] "I will make the sun's shadow that falls on the stairway of Ahaz go back ten steps.'" So the sunlight went back the ten steps it had descended. [9] This is a writing by Hezekiah king of Judah after his illness and recovery: [10] I said, "In the prime of my life I must go through the gates of Sheol and be deprived of the remainder of my years." [11] I said, "I will never again see the LORD, even the LORD, in the land of the living; I will no longer look on mankind with those who dwell in this world." [12] My dwelling has been picked up and removed from me like a shepherd's tent. I have rolled up my life like a weaver; He cuts me off from the loom; from day until night You make an end of me. [13] I composed myself until the morning. Like a lion He breaks all my bones; from day until night You make an end of me.

[14] "I chirp like a swallow or crane; I moan like a dove. My eyes grow weak as I look upward. O Lord, I am oppressed; be my security." [15] What can I say? He has spoken to me, and He Himself has done this. I will walk slowly all my years because of the anguish of my soul. [16] O Lord, by such things men live, and in all of them my spirit finds life. You have restored me to health and have let me live.

[17] Surely for my own welfare I had such great anguish; but Your love has delivered me from the pit of oblivion, for You have cast all my sins behind Your back. [18] For Sheol cannot thank You; Death cannot praise You. Those who descend to the Pit cannot hope for Your faithfulness. [19] The living, only the living, can thank You, as I do today; fathers will tell their children about Your faithfulness. [20] The LORD will save me; we will play songs on stringed instruments all the days of our lives in the house of the LORD. [21] Now Isaiah had said, "Prepare a lump of pressed figs and apply it to the boil, and he will recover." [22] And Hezekiah had asked, "What will be the sign that I will go up to the house of the LORD?"

39 At that time Merodach-baladan son of Baladan king of Babylon sent letters and a gift to Hezekiah, for he had heard about Hezekiah's illness and recovery. [2] And Hezekiah welcomed the envoys gladly and showed them what was in his treasure house—the silver, the gold, the spices, and the precious oil, as well as his entire armory—all that was found in his storehouses. There was nothing in his palace or in all his dominion that Hezekiah did not show them. [3] Then the prophet Isaiah went to King Hezekiah and asked, "Where did those men come from, and what did they say to you?" "They came to me from a distant land," Hezekiah replied, "from Babylon." [4] "What have they seen in your palace?" Isaiah asked. "They have seen everything in my palace," answered Hezekiah. "There is nothing among my treasures that I did not show them." [5] Then Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Hear the word of the LORD of Hosts: " [6] The time will surely come when everything in your palace and all that your fathers have stored up until this day will be carried off to Babylon. Nothing will be left, says the LORD. [7] "And some of your descendants, your own flesh and blood, will be taken away to be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon." [8] But Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "The word of the LORD that you have spoken is good." For he thought, "At least there will be peace and security in my lifetime."

40 "Comfort, comfort My people," says your God. [2] "Speak tenderly to Jerusalem, and proclaim to her that her forced labor has been completed; her iniquity has been pardoned. For she has received from the hand of the LORD double for all her sins." [3] A voice of one calling: "Prepare the way for the LORD in the wilderness; make a straight highway for our God in the desert." [4] Every valley

shall be lifted up, and every mountain and hill made low; the uneven ground will become smooth, and the rugged land a plain. [5] "And the glory of the LORD will be revealed, and all humanity together will see it. For the mouth of the LORD has spoken." [6] A voice says, "Cry out!" And I asked, "What should I cry out?" "All flesh is like grass, and all its glory like the flowers of the field." [7] The grass withers and the flowers fall when the breath of the LORD blows on them; indeed, the people are grass. [8] "The grass withers and the flowers fall, but the word of our God stands forever." [9] Go up on a high mountain, O Zion, herald of good news. Raise your voice loudly, O Jerusalem, herald of good news. Lift it up, do not be afraid! Say to the cities of Judah, "Here is your God!"

[10] Behold, the Lord GOD comes with might, and His arm establishes His rule. His reward is with Him, and His recompense accompanies Him. [11] He tends His flock like a shepherd; He gathers the lambs in His arms and carries them close to His heart. He gently leads the nursing ewes. [12] Who has measured the waters in the hollow of his hand, or marked off the heavens with the span of his hand? Who has held the dust of the earth in a basket, or weighed the mountains on a scale and the hills with a balance? [13] Who has directed the Spirit of the LORD, or informed Him as His counselor? [14] Whom did He consult to enlighten Him, and who taught Him the paths of justice? Who imparted knowledge to Him and showed Him the way of understanding? [15] Surely the nations are like a drop in a bucket; they are considered a speck of dust on the scales; He lifts up the islands like fine dust. [16] Lebanon is not sufficient for fuel, nor its animals enough for a burnt offering. [17] All the nations are as nothing before Him; He regards them as nothingness and emptiness. [18] To whom will you liken God? To what image will you compare Him? [19] To an idol that a craftsman casts and a metalworker overlays with gold and fits with silver chains?

[20] To one bereft of an offering who chooses wood that will not rot, who seeks a skilled craftsman to set up an idol that will not topple? [21] Do you not know? Have you not heard? Has it not been declared to you from the beginning? Have you not understood since the foundation of the earth? [22] He sits enthroned above the circle of the earth; its dwellers are like grasshoppers. He stretches out the heavens like a curtain, and spreads them out like a tent to dwell in. [23] He brings the princes to nothing and makes the rulers of the earth meaningless. [24] No sooner are they planted, no sooner are they sown, no sooner have their stems taken root in the ground, than He blows on them and they wither, and a whirlwind sweeps them away like stubble. [25] "To whom will you liken Me, or who is My equal?" asks the Holy One. [26] Lift up your eyes on high: Who created all these? He leads forth the starry host by number; He calls each one by name. Because of His great power and mighty strength, not one of them is missing. [27] Why do you say, O Jacob, and why do you assert, O Israel, "My way is hidden from the LORD, and my claim is ignored by my God"?

[28] Do you not know? Have you not heard? The LORD is the everlasting God, the Creator of the ends of the earth. He will not grow tired or weary; His understanding is beyond searching out. [29] He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak. [30] Even youths grow tired and weary, and young men stumble and fall. [31] But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint.

41 "Be silent before Me, O islands, and let the peoples renew their strength. Let them come forward and testify; let us together draw near for judgment." [2] Who has aroused one from the east and called him to his feet in righteousness? He hands nations over to him and subdues kings before him. He turns them to dust with his sword, to windblown chaff with his bow. [3] He pursues them, going on safely, hardly touching the path with his feet. [4] "Who has performed this and carried it out, calling forth the generations from the beginning? I, the LORD—the first and the last— I am He." [5] The islands see and fear; the ends of the earth tremble. They approach and come forward. [6] Each one helps the other and says to his brother, "Be strong!" [7] The craftsman encourages the goldsmith, and he who wields the hammer cheers him who strikes the anvil, saying of the welding, "It is good." He nails it down so it will not be toppled. [8] "But you, O Israel, My servant, Jacob, whom I have chosen, descendant of Abraham My friend—"

[9] I brought you from the ends of the earth and called you from its farthest corners. I said, 'You are My servant.' I have chosen and not rejected you. [10] Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness. [11] Behold, all who rage against you will be ashamed and disgraced; those who contend with you will be reduced to nothing and will perish. [12] You will seek them but will not find them. Those who wage war against you will come to nothing. [13] For I am the LORD your God, who takes hold of your right hand and tells you: Do not fear, I will help you. [14] "Do not fear, O worm of Jacob, O few men of Israel. I will help you," declares the LORD. "Your Redeemer is the Holy One of Israel."

[15] Behold, I will make you into a threshing sledge, new and sharp, with many teeth. You will thresh the mountains and crush them, and reduce the hills to chaff. [16] You will winnow them, and a wind will carry them away; a gale will scatter them. But you will rejoice in the LORD; you will glory in the Holy One of Israel. [17] The poor and needy seek water, but there is none; their tongues are parched with thirst. I, the LORD, will answer them; I, the God of Israel, will not forsake them. [18] I will open rivers on the barren heights, and fountains in the middle of the valleys. I will turn the desert into a pool of water, and the dry land into flowing springs.

[19] I will plant cedars in the wilderness, acacias, myrtles, and olive trees. I will set cypresses in the desert, elms and boxwood together, [20] "so that all may see and know, may consider and understand, that the hand of the LORD has done this and the Holy One of Israel has created it." [21] "Present your case," says the LORD. "Submit your arguments," says the King of Jacob. [22] "Let them come and tell us what will happen. Tell the former things, so that we may reflect on them and know the outcome. Or announce to us what is coming." [23] Tell us the things that are to come, so that we may know that you are gods. Yes, do something good or evil, that we may look on together in dismay. [24] Behold, you are nothing and your work is of no value. Anyone who chooses you is detestable. [25] I have raised up one from the north, and he has come— one from the east who calls on My name. He will march over rulers as if they were mortar, like a potter who treads the clay. [26] Who has declared this from the beginning, so that we may know, and from times past, so that we may say: 'He was right'? No one announced it, no one foretold it, no one heard your words. [27] I was the first to tell Zion: 'Look, here they are!' And I gave to Jerusalem a herald of good news. [28] When I look, there is no one; there is no counselor among them; when I ask them, they have nothing to say. [29] See, they are all a delusion; their works amount to nothing; their images are as empty as the wind.

42 "Here is My Servant, whom I uphold, My Chosen One, in whom My soul delights. I will put My Spirit on Him, and He will bring justice to the nations." [2] He will not cry out or raise His voice, nor make His voice heard in the streets. [3] A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice. [4] "He will not grow weak or discouraged before He has established justice on the earth. In His law the islands will put their hope." [5] This is what God the LORD says— He who created the heavens and stretched them out, who spread out the earth and its offspring, who gives breath to the people on it and life to those who walk in it: [6] "I, the LORD, have called you for a righteous purpose, and I will take hold of your hand. I will keep you and appoint you to be a covenant for the people and a light to the nations," [7] to open the eyes of the blind, to bring prisoners out of the dungeon and those sitting in darkness out from the prison house.

[8] I am the LORD; that is My name! I will not yield My glory to another or My praise to idols. [9] "Behold, the former things have happened, and now I declare new things. Before they spring forth I proclaim them to you." [10] Sing to the LORD a new song— His praise from the ends of the earth— you who go down to the sea, and all that is in it, you islands, and all who dwell in them. [11] Let the desert and its cities raise their voices; let the villages of Kedar cry aloud. Let the people of Sela sing for joy; let them cry out from the mountaintops.

[12] Let them give glory to the LORD and declare His praise in the islands. [13] The LORD goes forth like a mighty one; He stirs up His zeal like a warrior. He shouts; yes, He roars in triumph over His enemies: [14] "I have kept silent from ages past; I have remained quiet and restrained. But now I will groan like a woman in labor; I will at once gasp and pant." [15] I will lay waste the mountains and hills and dry up all their vegetation. I will turn the rivers into dry land and drain the marshes.

[16] I will lead the blind by a way they did not know; I will guide them on unfamiliar paths. I will turn darkness into light before them and rough places into level ground. These things I will do for them, and I will not forsake them. [17] But those who trust in idols and say to molten images, 'You are our gods!' will be turned back in utter shame. [18] Listen, you deaf ones; look, you blind ones, that you may see! [19] Who is blind but My servant, or deaf like the messenger I am sending? Who is blind like My covenant partner, or blind like the servant of the LORD? [20] "Though seeing many things, you do not keep watch. Though your ears are open, you do not hear." [21] The LORD was pleased, for the sake of His righteousness, to magnify His law and make it glorious. [22] But this is a people plundered and looted, all trapped in caves or imprisoned in dungeons. They have become plunder with no one to rescue them, and loot with no one to say, "Send them back!" [23] Who among you will pay attention to this? Who will listen and obey hereafter? [24] Who gave Jacob up for spoil, and Israel to the plunderers? Was it not the LORD, against whom we have sinned? They were unwilling to walk in His ways, and they would not obey His law. [25] So He poured out on them His furious anger and the fierceness of battle. It enveloped them in flames, but they did not understand; it consumed them, but they did not take it to heart.

43 Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: "Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!" [2] When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze. [3] For I am the LORD your God, the Holy One of Israel, your Savior; I give Egypt for your ransom, Cush and Seba in your place. [4] Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations

in place of your life. [5] Do not be afraid, for I am with you; I will bring your offspring
from the east and gather you from the west. [6] I will say to the north, 'Give them
up!' and to the south, 'Do not hold them back!' Bring My sons from afar, and My
daughters from the ends of the earth— [7] "everyone called by My name and created
for My glory, whom I have indeed formed and made." [8] Bring out a people who
have eyes but are blind, and who have ea[redacted] but are deaf.

[9] All the nations gather together and the peoples assemble. Who among them can
declare this, and proclaim to us the former things? Let them present their witnesses
to vindicate them, so that others may hear and say, "It is true." [10] "You are My
witnesses," declares the LORD, "and My servant whom I have chosen, so that you
may consider and believe Me and understand that I am He. Before Me no god was
formed, and after Me none will come."